

UNIFIED FILLABLE WORKBOOK

# Market Dominating Position System

A complete shop-focused workbook for metal fabrication, welding, machining, manufacturing, and installation companies that want to win better work through clearer positioning, stronger proof, better customer fit, and better quote discipline.

BUILT FOR SHOPS THAT QUOTE, FABRICATE, WELD, MACHINE, AND INSTALL

## One workbook. One system. One market message.

Use this unified workbook to define the buyer you serve, the problem you remove, the advantage you can prove, and the actions your team must take so the message is believable.

### Position

Clarify why the right buyer should choose your shop.

### Customer fit

Identify best-fit accounts and project types.

### Proof and action

Turn the message into forms, proof assets, and outreach.

# How to use this unified book

This is one practical system: identify the buyer, define the value, prove the claim, package the offer, qualify the RFQ, and turn the message into repeatable sales and operating behavior.

## 1. Choose the market lane

Define the buyer, project type, industry, facility, or production problem where your shop can become the obvious choice.

## 2. Identify buyer urgency

Capture the risks, delays, frustrations, budget pressure, schedule pressure, and proof needs that move the decision.

## 3. Build the advantage

Choose the strongest mix of service, selection, pricing, speed, education, risk control, quality proof, and documentation.

## 4. Prove the promise

Connect the message to estimating standards, scope notes, QA, welding, production, delivery, install, and follow-up.

## 5. Execute the message

Use the worksheets to build proposal language, outreach scripts, RFQ filters, proof assets, and a 90-day rollout plan.

### RULE

## Keep the system practical.

The final position should be simple enough for the team to understand, repeat, and use.

# Workbook map

Work straight through or jump to the phase that solves your immediate problem. The worksheet pages are fillable, but every page can also be printed and completed by hand.

**Foundation and market lane**

Pages 4-12

**Target customer and low-hanging fruit**

Pages 13-25

**Service, selection, and pricing advantage**

Pages 26-41

**Proof, operations, and delivery discipline**

Pages 42-47

**Sales message, RFQ qualification, and outreach**

Pages 48-55

**Implementation and final system brief**

Pages 56-60

## **BEST WAY TO USE IT**

### **Use real buyer language.**

Pull phrases from RFQs, bid reviews, site walks, kickoff meetings, change orders, and closeout conversations.

# Foundation and market lane

Start by defining the market lane where your shop can win on value instead of acting like every other fabricator competing on price.

- 1 Clarify the specific buyer, industry, project type, material, or problem you want to be known for.
- 2 Name the painful problem your shop can remove.
- 3 Connect the promise to real operating proof, not just a slogan.

## CORE IDEA

# Price becomes the default when value is unclear.

When a buyer cannot see a meaningful difference between shops, the conversation moves toward price, lead time, and who feels easiest to deal with. Strong positioning makes the value visible before the buyer compares numbers.

## Buyer sees no difference

The conversation becomes: how much, how fast, and can you sharpen the number?

## Buyer sees clear value

The conversation becomes: can you reduce our risk, clean up scope, protect schedule, and make the handoff easier?

## SHOP REALITY

## Manufacturing buyers pay for certainty.

The right position shows how your shop reduces surprises in quoting, material, welding, quality, install, change orders, documentation, and delivery.

## DEFINITION

# What is a market-dominating position?

A market-dominating position is a customer-perceived advantage strong enough to make your shop the logical choice for a specific buyer, project type, industry, material, risk profile, or production problem.

## Not just a slogan

The claim must be backed by estimating, planning, fabrication, welding, QA, shipping, install, and follow-up.

## Not just low price

The goal is to increase buyer confidence without destroying margin.

## Not for everyone

It should fit a specific buyer, project type, risk profile, or manufacturing need.

## SIMPLE DEFINITION

## A clear reason to choose your shop.

Your position explains why the right target customer should choose your shop instead of another fabricator, welding contractor, machine shop, broker, importer, or in-house option.

## SYSTEM MAP

# A strong shop position is built in five decisions.

Each decision narrows the market, sharpens the promise, and connects the sales message to what the operation can actually deliver.

## 1. Market lane

Which buyer, project type, material, industry, or production problem will you focus on?

## 2. Buyer pain

What risk, delay, confusion, cost, or pressure does the buyer want removed?

## 3. Primary advantage

What is the strongest reason the right buyer should choose your shop?

## 4. Proof system

What process, standard, checklist, documentation, or operating behavior proves the claim?

## 5. Clear message

How will you explain the difference in one sentence buyers can repeat?

**IMPORTANT**

## Do not skip the proof system.

A promise without operating discipline creates disappointed customers. Your position should be something the shop can prove, repeat, and improve.

## POSITIONING STACK

# Your position should stack value, not slogans.

A strong position is built in layers. The buyer should feel the advantage before they compare prices.

**Target buyer**

The exact account, market, project type, or facility you intend to win.

**Urgent problem**

The risk, delay, frustration, rework, scope issue, or inefficiency they want removed.

**Primary promise**

The strongest benefit they get by choosing your shop.

**Proof system**

The checklist, method, standard, documentation, or operating process behind the claim.

**Clear message**

The sentence your market remembers and repeats.

**RULE****If the stack is weak, the statement will be weak.**

Do not jump to a tagline. Build the value underneath it first.



## WORKSHEET

# Choose the lane your shop can own.

This page forces the positioning decision. Be specific enough that your team knows what work to pursue and what work to stop chasing.

**TARGET CUSTOMER, INDUSTRY, OR PROJECT SEGMENT**

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**UNMET NEED, FRUSTRATION, RISK, OR EXPENSIVE PROBLEM**

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**SHOP STRENGTH THAT CAN SOLVE IT**

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**STRATEGIC POSITION DRAFT**

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## WORKSHEET

# Identify the buyer your position should attract.

A position only matters if it points toward the buyers, industries, projects, and situations most likely to value it.

## START HERE

## The real question

Which customers already feel the pain your shop can remove - and are most likely to pay for certainty, quality, speed, documentation, scope clarity, or field execution?

### BEST CURRENT CUSTOMERS YOU WOULD WANT MORE OF

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### WHY THEY ARE A GOOD FIT FOR YOUR SHOP

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### CUSTOMERS OR JOBS THAT ARE NOT A GOOD FIT

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**FROM GENERIC TO SPECIFIC**

# A generic shop becomes stronger when the buyer experience is specific.

The old approach is to say, "we do fabrication, welding, machining, and installation." A stronger approach explains the specific buyer experience you create and why it matters.

**Generic offer**

We do fabrication, welding, machining, and installation.

**Specific buyer experience**

We help plant managers get clear scope, fast budget numbers, documented handoff, and fewer shutdown surprises.

**SHOP TRANSLATION**

## Positioning improves when the buyer can see the experience.

Create contrast with better RFQ intake, drawing review notes, material options, weld/finish guidance, photo proof, quote assumptions, schedule visibility, and cleaner handoffs.

## WORKSHEET

# Translate the lesson into your shop.

Turn a generic capability into a buyer-specific experience that can be explained, sold, and delivered.

**GENERIC SERVICE OR CAPABILITY YOU CURRENTLY OFFER**

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**SPECIFIC BUYER WHO WOULD VALUE IT MOST**

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**BUYER EXPERIENCE YOU COULD BUILD AROUND IT**

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**PROOF, PROCESS, OR TOOL THAT WOULD MAKE IT BELIEVABLE**

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# Target customer and low-hanging fruit

The strongest position gets more powerful when it is aimed at the right buyer. This phase defines who already has the problem, values the solution, and can be reached.

- 1 Build an account profile that fits your shop and your margin.
- 2 Name the buyer hot buttons that create urgency.
- 3 Score opportunities before you waste estimating and sales time.

LOW-HANGING FRUIT

# Low-hanging fruit is not just the easiest sale.

In fabrication and manufacturing, low-hanging fruit means the buyer already has a painful problem, values the way your shop solves it, has budget or authority, and can be reached without forcing the sale.

## Problem fit

They have RFQ chaos, quality issues, schedule pressure, capacity gaps, or handoff problems.

## Value fit

They care about proof, communication, risk control, documentation, or reliability.

## Access fit

You can reach them through current customers, referrals, niche content, trade partners, or prior work.

## WHERE DO BUYERS ALREADY SHOW URGENCY?

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## WHAT KIND OF BUYER VALUES YOUR STRENGTHS BEFORE PRICE?

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**FOUR FILTERS**

# There are four ways to find your best target customer.

Use these filters to decide who to pursue, who to ignore, and what message should lead the sales conversation.

## 1. Account profile

Industry, facility type, company size, location, buying role, and technical requirements.

## 2. Buyer hot buttons

The fears, pressures, frustrations, risks, and outcomes that move the decision.

## 3. Project profile

Job type, material, tolerance, quantity, schedule, installation, quality, and margin fit.

## 4. Buying process

How they approve vendors, compare quotes, value service, and handle risk.

**RULE**

## A good filter makes sales easier.

If the filter does not help you decide who to pursue, who to ignore, or what message to use, it is too vague.

ACCOUNT PROFILE

# Define the company profile your shop should pursue.

For shops selling B2B, target customer data is less about personal demographics and more about the account profile. You are looking for the companies, plants, contractors, OEMs, and project owners that fit your shop.

Industry

Food processing, marine, energy, construction, infrastructure, manufacturing, equipment, or another niche.

Facility / project type

Plant, shipyard, jobsite, warehouse, commercial build, outage, OEM line, or custom build.

Technical fit

Material, weld process, tolerance, finish, QA, documentation, install, and delivery requirements.

Access

Past work, referral paths, local network, trade partners, bid lists, LinkedIn, or direct outreach.

ACCOUNT TYPES THAT FIT YOUR SHOP BEST



## WORKSHEET

# Build your best-fit account profile.

Be specific enough that an estimator, salesperson, or owner could recognize the right account when they see it.

**INDUSTRIES OR FACILITY TYPES WE SHOULD TARGET**

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**COMPANY SIZE, LOCATION, OR BUYING SITUATION THAT FITS US**

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**TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS WE ARE STRONG AT SUPPORTING**

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**ACCOUNT TYPES WE SHOULD STOP CHASING**

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## BUYER HOT BUTTONS

# Identify the pressure behind the buying decision.

Buyers justify decisions with numbers, but urgency usually comes from pressure. In fabrication and manufacturing, the pressure often lives around missed deadlines, unclear scope, quality risk, rework, shutdown windows, budget surprises, and communication gaps.

**Fear**

What happens if this shop misses schedule, quality, scope, or handoff?

**Frustration**

What does the buyer hate repeating, chasing, explaining, or correcting?

**Outcome**

What would make the buyer look good internally?

**Risk**

What could cost them money, time, safety, production, reputation, or trust?

## SALES CLARITY

**Hot buttons should sound like buyer language.**

Use phrases you hear in RFQs, job walks, bid reviews, emails, kickoff meetings, and closeout conversations.

**WORKSHEET**

# Write the hot buttons in the buyer's words.

Do not write what your shop wants to sell. Write what the buyer wants solved.

**WHAT THEY ARE TIRED OF DEALING WITH**

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**WHAT THEY ARE WORRIED WILL GO WRONG**

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**WHAT WOULD MAKE THEM LOOK GOOD TO THEIR TEAM OR CUSTOMER**

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**WHAT THEY WOULD PAY MORE TO AVOID**

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PROJECT PROFILE

# Define the project or job profile that actually fits your shop.

Not every account is profitable for every job. The best target customer profile should include the kind of work your shop can estimate accurately, produce consistently, and protect margin on.

**Work type**  
Structural, misc metals, stairs, railings, skids, platforms, stainless, aluminum, maintenance, production, or field work.

**Job size**  
Small repeat work, mid-size packages, high-value custom jobs, shutdown work, or ongoing production.

**Complexity**  
Drawings, tolerances, weld procedures, finish requirements, documentation, and install risk.

**Margin fit**  
Work that fits your equipment, crew, suppliers, systems, and quoting logic.

**PROJECT TYPES THAT ARE A STRONG FIT**  

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## WORKSHEET

# Separate profitable fit from distracting work.

Get honest about the jobs your shop should pursue more often and the jobs that drain estimating time, shop capacity, and margin.

**OUR MOST PROFITABLE OR REPEATABLE JOB TYPES**

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**JOBS THAT LOOK GOOD BUT CREATE TOO MUCH RISK OR DRAG**

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**MATERIALS, PROCESSES, OR PROJECT CONDITIONS WE HANDLE WELL**

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**RED FLAGS THAT SHOULD MAKE US QUALIFY HARDER OR DECLINE**

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BUYING PROCESS

# Define the buying process and service level your shop should target.

Some buyers want the lowest number. Others want certainty, documentation, fast answers, technical guidance, or a clean handoff. Your strongest target customers are the buyers whose buying process rewards the things your shop does well.

## Approval path

Who signs off: owner, buyer, PM, engineer, plant manager, GC, maintenance lead, or procurement?

## Decision criteria

Do they compare price only, or do they value lead time, quality, documentation, and trust?

## Service expectation

Do they need updates, field coordination, reviewed drawings, or help defining scope?

## Price level

Do they understand that lower risk, clearer scope, and better proof should cost more?

## BUYING PROCESS WHERE OUR SHOP HAS AN ADVANTAGE

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WORKSHEET

# Target customer qualification scorecard.

Score each potential target segment. The best low-hanging fruit is not just easy to contact. It has urgent need, good fit, profit potential, and a reason to trust your proof.

| FILTER                  | CURRENT SCORE                                                                                                                             | NOTES / EVIDENCE |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| Problem urgency         | <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/><br>1 2 3 4 5 | <hr/> <hr/>      |
| Technical fit           | <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/><br>1 2 3 4 5 | <hr/> <hr/>      |
| Margin potential        | <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/><br>1 2 3 4 5 | <hr/> <hr/>      |
| Repeat potential        | <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/><br>1 2 3 4 5 | <hr/> <hr/>      |
| Decision access         | <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/><br>1 2 3 4 5 | <hr/> <hr/>      |
| Values proof over price | <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/><br>1 2 3 4 5 | <hr/> <hr/>      |
| Can reach them now      | <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/><br>1 2 3 4 5 | <hr/> <hr/>      |
| Good referral potential | <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/> <input type="checkbox"/><br>1 2 3 4 5 | <hr/> <hr/>      |

DECISION RULE

**Pursue the segment with the strongest combined fit.**

A high score means the buyer has pain, values your solution, fits your operation, and is reachable.

WORKSHEET

# Rank your best target segments.

Compare possible target segments side by side. The best segment is not just large. It is urgent, reachable, profitable, repeatable, and connected to your strongest proof.

| Target segment | Urgency                                      | Fit                                          | Margin                                       | Access                                       | Message to test |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|-----------------|
|                | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> |                 |
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|                |                                              |                                              |                                              |                                              |                 |

DECISION RULE

## Pick one primary target first.

A focused message aimed at one urgent segment will usually outperform a vague message aimed at everyone.



## WORKSHEET

# Decide what you will stop chasing.

Positioning gets sharper when your team knows what not to pursue. Use this page to protect estimating time, shop capacity, and margin.

**LOW-VALUE JOBS THAT CONSUME TOO MUCH ESTIMATING TIME**

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**CUSTOMER BEHAVIORS THAT SIGNAL POOR FIT**

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**TECHNICAL WORK OUTSIDE OUR RELIABLE CAPABILITY**

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**MARGIN, SCHEDULE, OR PAYMENT RISKS WE SHOULD AVOID**

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# Service, selection, and pricing advantage

This phase turns your target customer insight into a buyer-facing advantage. The goal is to choose what your market will feel, value, and believe.

- 1 Service can create contrast when the customer experience is easier and more certain.
- 2 Selection can make you easier to choose when it solves a real buyer problem.
- 3 Pricing should support the value proposition instead of replacing it.

## PRIMARY ADVANTAGE

# Choose the strongest reason buyers should choose your shop.

Your primary advantage should connect directly to what the buyer cares about most: certainty, schedule, quality, scope clarity, capacity, risk, speed, or documentation.

## Convenience

Make RFQs, approvals, updates, and handoffs easier.

## Speed

Reduce quote delays, decision time, lead-time confusion, or recovery time.

## Risk removal

Lower fear around drawings, tolerances, schedule, install, or change orders.

## Quality proof

Show standards, checkpoints, weld quality, inspections, and documentation.

### YOUR PRIMARY ADVANTAGE IN PLAIN LANGUAGE

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### HOW THE BUYER WILL EXPERIENCE THIS ADVANTAGE

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**SERVICE ADVANTAGE**

# Service can be the reason manufacturing buyers choose you.

Service is more than being friendly. In fabrication and manufacturing, service includes RFQ clarity, speed, education, risk control, quality proof, safety, documentation, and the overall buyer experience.

**Convenience**

Save the buyer time and effort.

**Speed**

Remove waiting and friction.

**Education**

Make the buyer smarter before and after the order.

**Risk removal**

Make saying yes feel safer.

**Quality**

Make standards visible.

**Safety / security**

Protect people, property, data, and compliance.

**STRATEGY**

## Use service to create contrast.

A competitor can copy a price. It is harder to copy a customer experience your team delivers consistently from RFQ through delivery.

WORKSHEET

# Where can you make the buyer experience easier?

Score each area. Then write one improvement that would make doing business with your shop easier than choosing a competitor.

| FILTER                     | CURRENT SCORE            |                          |                          |                          |                          | NOTES / EVIDENCE |
|----------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|------------------|
| RFQ intake                 | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                  |
|                            | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        |                  |
| Drawing / scope review     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                  |
|                            | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        |                  |
| Quote approval             | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                  |
|                            | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        |                  |
| Project updates            | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                  |
|                            | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        |                  |
| Delivery / install handoff | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                  |
|                            | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        |                  |
| Payment / documentation    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                  |
|                            | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        |                  |
|                            |                          |                          |                          |                          |                          |                  |

DECISION RULE

## Best opportunity

Choose the buyer friction your industry treats as normal, then remove it.

## SPEED

# Speed wins when the customer values time, certainty, or momentum.

Speed does not always mean rushing fabrication. It can mean faster answers, faster estimates, faster drawing review, faster approvals, faster mobilization, or faster recovery when something goes wrong.

## What speed can look like

24-hour RFQ response, 48-hour budget number, same-day scope clarification, priority production slot, quick-start kickoff, or clear answers.

## What makes speed believable

Published timelines, dedicated estimating capacity, intake forms, material checks, handoff rules, escalation triggers, and recovery plans.

## WHERE DO YOUR CUSTOMERS CURRENTLY WAIT?

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## WHAT FASTER RESULT WOULD THEY ACTUALLY VALUE?

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## WHAT OPERATIONAL CHANGE WOULD BE REQUIRED TO DELIVER IT?

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## EDUCATION

# Education turns shop expertise into a customer advantage.

Many buyers do not fully understand fabrication constraints, welding processes, tolerances, finishing, material risk, or installation tradeoffs. Clear education makes your shop safer to choose.

## Drawing review notes

Help buyers understand scope gaps and assumptions.

## Material guidance

Explain availability, substitutions, waste, and pricing risk.

## Weld / finish guidance

Show options, tradeoffs, and standards.

## Install or handoff plan

Explain what happens after award so the buyer sees control.

## EDUCATION IDEAS YOUR BUYERS WOULD VALUE

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**RISK REVERSAL**

# Remove the fear that stops buyers from saying yes.

Risk reversal is any proof, promise, process, documentation, inspection point, policy, or safeguard that makes the buyer feel safer choosing your shop.

**Scope clarity**

What is included, excluded, assumed, and unknown?

**Change-order process**

How are changes documented and approved?

**Schedule proof**

How do you show timeline control?

**Quality checkpoints**

Where do inspections happen?

**Material risk control**

How do you manage lead times and substitutions?

**Warranty / correction**

What happens if something needs fixing?

**BIGGEST PERCEIVED RISK IN BUYING FROM YOUR SHOP OR INDUSTRY**

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**QUALITY PROOF**

# Quality only works as a differentiator when the buyer can see it.

Almost every shop says it does quality work. A market position requires proof: standards, inspection points, photos, weld procedures, checklists, certifications, traceability, and named accountability.

**Weak claim**

We do high-quality fabrication and take pride in our work.

**Stronger proof**

Every job follows a documented drawing review, fit-up checkpoint, weld inspection, photo verification, and final release step.

**WHAT PROOF CAN YOU SHOW BEFORE THE BUYER COMMITS?**

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**WHAT QUALITY STANDARD CAN YOUR TEAM CONSISTENTLY DELIVER?**

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**VALUE ADD****Make the invisible visible.**

Photos, checklists, inspections, scope notes, and handoff summaries make quality visible early.

SAFETY AND DOCUMENTATION

# Safety, compliance, and documentation can become buying advantages.

Some manufacturing buyers care deeply about safety programs, site access, insurance, compliance, documentation, data privacy, asset protection, and reducing liability.

Site safety

JSAs, orientation, PPE, lift plans, hot-work controls.

Documentation

WPS, inspection records, drawings, MTRs, photos, signoffs.

Financial / scope safety

Clear terms, no surprise charges, written approvals.

Facility protection

Clean work areas, controlled access, outage planning, damage prevention.

SAFETY / COMPLIANCE OPPORTUNITIES

WORKSHEET

# Choose your strongest service-based advantage.

Score each service lever for buyer value and operational ability. The best positioning advantage matters to the buyer and can be delivered consistently.

| FILTER                 | CURRENT SCORE            |                          |                          |                          |                          | NOTES / EVIDENCE |
|------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|------------------|
| Convenience            | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                  |
|                        | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        |                  |
| Speed                  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                  |
|                        | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        |                  |
| Education / guidance   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                  |
|                        | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        |                  |
| Risk removal           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                  |
|                        | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        |                  |
| Quality proof          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                  |
|                        | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        |                  |
| Safety / documentation | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |                  |
|                        | 1                        | 2                        | 3                        | 4                        | 5                        |                  |

DECISION RULE

## Choose what buyers feel immediately.

Your strongest service position is the one buyers feel immediately and your team can prove repeatedly.

**SELECTION**

# Selection can make you easier to choose - if it solves a real buyer problem.

Selection includes fabrication capabilities, welding processes, materials, finishes, service levels, packages, production quantities, delivery options, and installation support.

**Capability range**

More options when buyers value one-stop support.

**Specialization**

Fewer options when buyers value deep expertise.

**Packages**

Helpful scopes that reduce decisions and approvals.

**Capacity / inventory**

Availability when buyers need certainty now.

**SELECTION RULE**

## Too much choice can create friction.

The advantage is not the number of options. The advantage is helping the buyer confidently choose the right fabrication path.

## WORKSHEET

# What selection advantage could you build?

Clarify whether your market wants more capability, better guidance, faster availability, or a bundled shop solution.

**WHAT CAPABILITIES DO CUSTOMERS ASK FOR MOST OFTEN?**

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**WHAT OPTIONS CONFUSE OR SLOW DOWN THE SALE?**

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**WHAT BUNDLE COULD MAKE THE DECISION EASIER?**

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**WHAT SPECIALIZED SERVICE COULD MAKE YOUR SHOP THE OBVIOUS CHOICE?**

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**WHAT SHOULD YOU STOP OFFERING BECAUSE IT CREATES COMPLEXITY WITHOUT VALUE?**

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## PRICING

# Price is a tool. It should not be the whole position.

If price is your only advantage, margin gets thin fast. Strong pricing works best when paired with service, selection, proof, clarity, and value.

## Fixed pricing

Make smaller scopes, audits, or packages simple and predictable.

## Price level

Use price to signal quality, capacity, specialization, or reduced risk.

## Value-added services

Increase perceived value with small extras buyers actually care about.

### PRICING RULE

## Never use price to compensate for unclear value.

If the buyer does not understand the value, a lower price often just makes the offer look weaker or riskier.

### PRICING NOTES

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## FIXED PRICING

# Fixed pricing can reduce uncertainty and make buying easier.

Defined packages, audits, site visits, engineering reviews, standard product lines, maintenance blocks, memberships, and bundled scopes can make your offer easier to approve.

**Flat fee**

One clear price for a defined result.

**Assessment**

Paid review, site walk, drawing audit, or quote cleanup.

**Bundle**

A package that combines related fabrication services.

**Service block**

A predictable amount of shop, field, or maintenance support.

**WHAT COULD YOU PACKAGE INTO A FIXED-PRICE OFFER?**

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**WHAT MUST BE CLEARLY INCLUDED AND EXCLUDED?**

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## VALUE-ADDED SERVICES

# Small value-added services can change how the price feels.

Value-added services do not have to be expensive. The goal is to add something the customer values more than it costs your shop to provide.

**Response**

Faster answers or direct access.

**Setup**

Kickoff, drawing review, or production handoff.

**Reporting**

Status updates, photos, or delivery summaries.

**Training**

Short guides, notes, or process explanations.

**Follow-up**

Check-ins after delivery or install.

**Documentation**

MTRs, weld docs, photos, checklists, or closeout packs.

**WHAT COULD YOU ADD THAT CUSTOMERS VALUE BUT COSTS LITTLE TO DELIVER?**

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## WORKSHEET

# Build the offer around the advantage.

Use this page to turn the market position into a clear offer that buyers can understand, approve, and repeat internally.

**PRIMARY OFFER OR SERVICE PACKAGE**

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**WHAT IS INCLUDED**

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**WHAT IS EXCLUDED OR REQUIRES CHANGE ORDER**

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**PROOF OR PROCESS INCLUDED WITH THE OFFER**

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**PRICING LOGIC OR VALUE JUSTIFICATION**

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# Proof, operations, and delivery discipline

The message must be backed by the way the shop actually runs. This phase connects sales promises to estimating, production, QA, welding, field work, documentation, and follow-up.

- 1 Define the operational proof behind the market claim.
- 2 Create proof assets that make value visible before the buyer commits.
- 3 Align estimating, sales, PM, shop, QA, and field teams around the promise.

**SUPPORT MODEL**

# Make the business model support the promise.

This is where positioning becomes real. A market promise needs estimating standards, drawing review, material strategy, weld procedures, production planning, quality checks, project communication, and follow-up behind it.

**If the position is speed**

RFQ intake, quoting capacity, material checks, and decision rules must support speed.

**If the position is quality**

The shop needs visible standards, inspections, photos, QA records, and accountability.

**If the position is schedule certainty**

Planning, handoffs, updates, and recovery triggers have to be tight.

**OPERATING RULE****The promise should be visible in how the company runs.**

If the customer cannot see how you deliver the claim, the message feels like marketing instead of proof.

## WORKSHEET

# Build the support model checklist.

Check what is already true. Use the notes field to identify what must be created, trained, or fixed.

**SUPPORT MODEL CHECKLIST**

- ☐ Estimating team knows the promise and quotes around it. \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ Customers see proof before they are asked to buy. \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ Drawing review, scope notes, and exclusions are standardized. \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ Production, welding, QA, shipping, and install know what was promised. \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ The promise does not depend on one hero employee saving the day. \_\_\_\_\_
- ☐ There is a recovery plan when scope, schedule, or quality drifts. \_\_\_\_\_

**ACTION**

## Turn weak areas into operating projects.

Turn missing proof into a checklist, template, training step, or standard process.

WORKSHEET

# Build a proof asset library.

Proof assets help buyers trust the claim before the job is complete. Build assets your sales and estimating team can use in quotes, proposals, follow-ups, and sales pages.

| ASSET                                                         | STATUS / OWNER |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Drawing review checklist             | <div></div>    |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Scope assumptions template           | <div></div>    |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Weld / QA checklist                  | <div></div>    |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Progress photo examples              | <div></div>    |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Closeout documentation sample        | <div></div>    |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Case study or before/after example   | <div></div>    |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Material / lead time explanation     | <div></div>    |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Delivery or install handoff template | <div></div>    |

RULE

## If you claim it, show it.

Every market promise should have at least one proof asset that a buyer can see before or during the sale.

**WORKSHEET**

# Map the promise to shop behavior.

A strong message should create a specific behavior in sales, estimating, production, QA, delivery, and follow-up.

**SALES / FIRST CONVERSATION BEHAVIOR**

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**ESTIMATING / QUOTE BEHAVIOR**

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**PRODUCTION / WELDING BEHAVIOR**

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**QA / DOCUMENTATION BEHAVIOR**

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**DELIVERY / INSTALL / FOLLOW-UP BEHAVIOR**

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## WORKSHEET

# Write the proof behind the claim.

This page connects the position to concrete proof. The goal is to make the claim believable before a buyer asks for a discount.

**THE MARKET CLAIM WE WANT TO MAKE**

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**PROOF WE CAN SHOW BEFORE THE SALE**

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**PROOF WE CAN SHOW DURING THE JOB**

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**PROOF WE CAN SHOW AFTER DELIVERY OR INSTALL**

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**PROOF WE STILL NEED TO BUILD**

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# Sales message, RFQ qualification, and outreach

Now turn the system into language that prospects, customers, estimators, PMs, and referral partners can understand and use.

- 1 Write the position statement and proof points.
- 2 Build proposal language and outreach messages.
- 3 Use RFQ qualification to protect time and margin.



## POSITION STATEMENT

# Turn the system into a clear market statement.

The final statement should make your shop easy to understand and hard to confuse with every other fabricator saying quality, service, and competitive pricing.

**Formula**

For [target customer], we provide [primary outcome] by [primary advantage], backed by [proof/support], so they can [desired result].

**Buyer test**

Can the buyer repeat it back clearly after hearing it once?

**SPECIFIC BUYER OR PROJECT TYPE**

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**SPECIFIC OUTCOME**

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**PRIMARY ADVANTAGE**

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**PROOF / SUPPORT SYSTEM**

**FINAL WORKSHEET**

# Write it until a buyer would repeat it back clearly.

A market position is not finished when it sounds clever. It is finished when the target buyer understands it, values it, and believes your shop can deliver it.

**DRAFT 1 - CLEAR BUT ROUGH**

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**DRAFT 2 - MORE SPECIFIC**

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**DRAFT 3 - SIMPLEST VERSION**

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**PROOF POINTS THAT MAKE IT BELIEVABLE**

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## WORKSHEET

# Build your elevator pitch.

The pitch should sound like something a real shop owner, estimator, or salesperson would say. Keep it direct.

**PROBLEM STATEMENT - WHAT THE BUYER IS DEALING WITH**

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**POSITION STATEMENT - HOW YOUR SHOP SOLVES IT**

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**PROOF - WHY THEY SHOULD BELIEVE IT**

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**NEXT STEP - WHAT YOU WANT THEM TO DO**

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**15-SECOND VERSION**

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## WORKSHEET

# Turn the position into proposal language.

Use this page to build wording that can go into quotes, proposal letters, capability statements, website sections, and follow-up emails.

**OPENING PARAGRAPH FOR PROPOSAL OR QUOTE**

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**SCOPE CLARITY / ASSUMPTIONS LANGUAGE**

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**PROOF / QUALITY / DOCUMENTATION LANGUAGE**

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**RISK REDUCTION LANGUAGE**

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## WORKSHEET

# Prepare for buyer objections.

A stronger position should make common objections easier to handle without racing to a lower price.

**IF THEY SAY: YOUR PRICE IS HIGHER**

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**IF THEY SAY: YOUR LEAD TIME IS LONGER**

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**IF THEY SAY: WHY SHOULD WE CHOOSE YOU?**

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**IF THEY SAY: HOW DO WE KNOW YOU CAN DELIVER?**

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**IF THEY SAY: WE ALREADY HAVE A VENDOR**

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FILLABLE FORM

# Use this before spending hours estimating.

This form helps qualify whether an RFQ fits the market position, target customer, operating strengths, and margin strategy.

|                               |                                                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| COMPANY / CONTACT             |                                                                                                                    |
| PROJECT TYPE                  |                                                                                                                    |
| DUE DATE / SCHEDULE PRESSURE  |                                                                                                                    |
| DECISION MAKER                |                                                                                                                    |
| BUDGET OR APPROVAL PATH       |                                                                                                                    |
| DRAWINGS / SCOPE CLARITY      |                                                                                                                    |
| QUALITY / DOCUMENTATION NEEDS |                                                                                                                    |
| BIGGEST BUYER CONCERN         |                                                                                                                    |
| FIT SCORE / NEXT ACTION       |                                                                                                                    |
| QUALIFICATION DECISION        | <input type="checkbox"/> Pursue <input type="checkbox"/> Qualify more <input type="checkbox"/> Decline / refer out |

## WORKSHEET

# Create simple outreach messages.

Use the position and target customer language to create messages that start real conversations without sounding generic.

**LINKEDIN CONNECTION OR FIRST MESSAGE**

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**COLD OR WARM EMAIL MESSAGE**

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**FOLLOW-UP MESSAGE**

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**REFERRAL PARTNER BLURB**

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# Implementation and final system brief

A market position only becomes valuable when the team uses it. Finish with actions, responsibilities, proof assets, and a one-page brief your team can use.

- 1 Turn the position into a 30/60/90-day operating plan.
- 2 Assign proof assets, process changes, and message tests.
- 3 Capture the entire system on one page.



**ACTION PLAN**

# Turn the position into shop behavior.

Use this plan to move from ideas to proof, sales material, and operating discipline.

**Days 1-30**

Choose the target buyer, final promise, core proof points, and RFQ qualification rules.

**Days 31-60**

Build proof assets: quote format, scope notes, photos, checklists, documentation, and handoff templates.

**Days 61-90**

Train sales, estimating, PM, shop, QA, and field teams. Test the message and track objections, wins, and confusion.

**ONE PROCESS TO IMPROVE SO THE PROMISE BECOMES TRUE**

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**MESSAGE TEST OR SALES MATERIAL TO UPDATE FIRST**

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CHECKLIST

# Roll the system out to the team.

A position that lives only in a workbook does not change the business. Use this checklist to make it operational.

| ROLLOUT ITEM                                               | OWNER / DATE |
|------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Final position statement approved |              |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Target customer filter approved   |              |
| <input type="checkbox"/> RFQ qualification form adopted    |              |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Proposal language updated         |              |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Proof assets built or assigned    |              |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Estimator and sales team trained  |              |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Shop / QA / field handoff aligned |              |
| <input type="checkbox"/> 30-day review scheduled           |              |

FINAL WORKSHEET

# Your one-page market system brief.

Use this as the handoff to your website, sales page, proposal template, LinkedIn profile, capability statement, or estimator sales script.

TARGET BUYER

PRIMARY PROBLEM

POSITION STATEMENT

PRIMARY PROOF

OPERATING COMMITMENTS

SALES MESSAGE TO TEST

# Before you use this in the market, complete these three actions.

1

**Choose the strongest market position angle and target customer segment.**

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2

**Write the clearest one-sentence position statement and proof points.**

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3

**Update one proposal, one sales page section, and one RFQ qualification process.**

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Keep this workbook open when you build your sales page, proposal letter, LinkedIn message, or estimator script. The final message should come from the actual value your shop can prove in estimating, fabrication, welding, quality, delivery, and follow-up.